

Fallow Space

A Brief Encyclopedia of
Interstellar Logistics

Substrate

Interstellar Logistics

There are voids in space.

Areas of low information on
the universe's membrane.

No stars, no objects, minimal
activity in the vacuum.

It's in any logistics firm's best
interest to keep it this way.

These immense voids are vital
for both the entire human species
and for a Station Hearts' survival.

Fallow Space must be empty
to cut, paste and entangle.

Complexity and Computing

The Computers need silence. They need Fallow Space, the cosmic deserts where the universe stops talking. Low information, high clarity. If you clutter a void, there is too much to process. The Computer sits useless, chugging over junk data and hacking blindly at the membrane.

$$\text{Complexity}(x) = (U+I) / C$$

Unpredictability (U):

Chaos, randomness, interference.

Information Density (I):

Atomic weight, matter, systems, interaction, history

Coherence (C):

Order, synchronisation, unity

The Duopoly

Opus Tech and Mirage Logistics (Known as The Duopoly) run all logistics transfers.

They have a seemingly endless contract for service delivery with the nodes. Every year that passes, they cement themselves as the only companies that *can* manage and maintain the infrastructure, making it impossible for any other organisations to claim a stake in the business.

Living Infrastructure

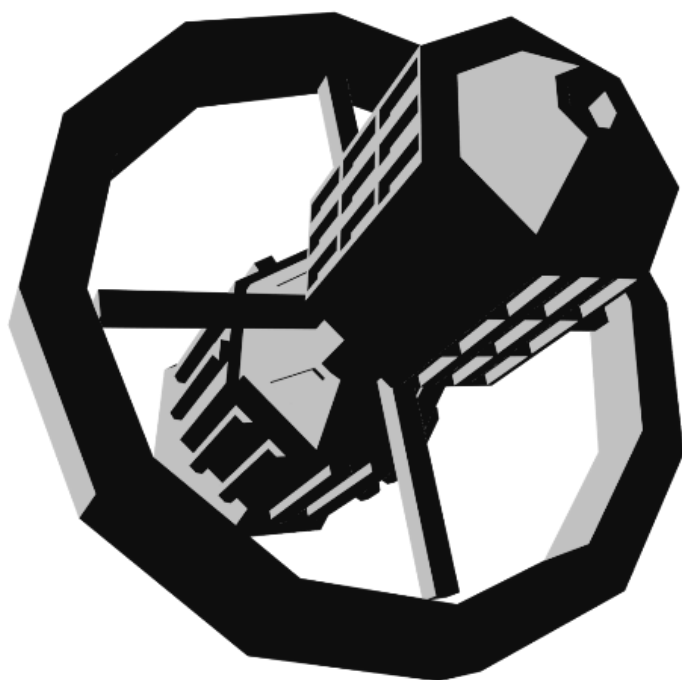
Space Stations

The diaspora of humans into the nearest parts of the galaxy happened in the same way as the expansion of the empires of old. Colonisation desiccated worlds, as it always had.

The growth of the first Station Heart changed this.

Each Heart is a lifeforce, synchronised with those of the residents.

Stations are primarily in existence for a now more sustainable harvesting of energy and matter.

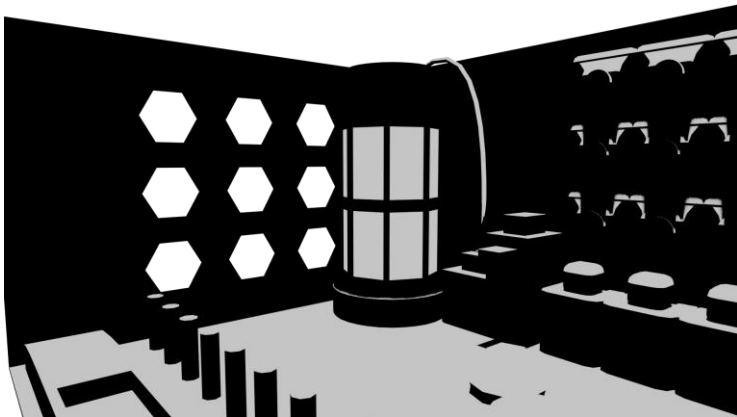


The Wolf 359 Station

Station Hearts

The first heart was grown by accident. A soup of energies in a lab, mixed to explore energy production techniques.

The enzyme of human connection did the rest. A catalyst for connection.



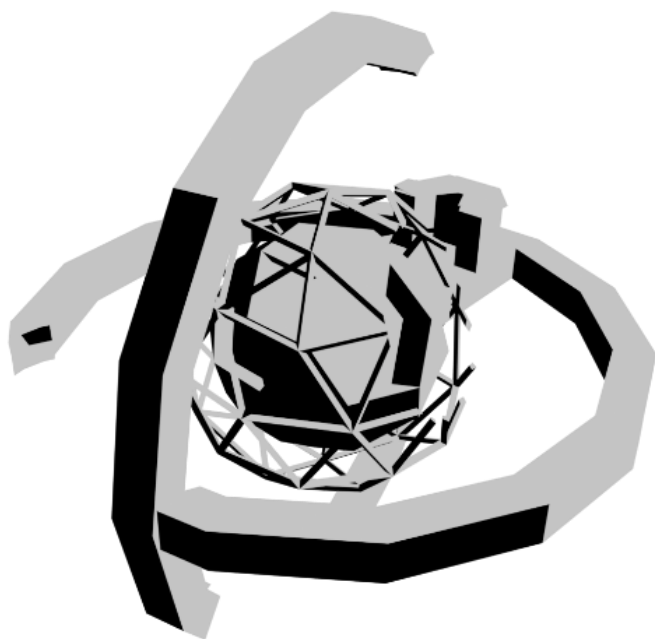
A Station Heart Room

Station Decay / Boneyard

Isolation and starvation, RGB
Addiction, Coherence starvation.
The main causes of Station Decay.

The computer still works.
Small crews sometimes travel to
harvest in these Boneyards.

Some are inhabited by
corporate refugees, others by
ineffable but very present Station
Ghosts.



The Groombridge 1618 Boneyard

Processing Systems

Transfer Computers

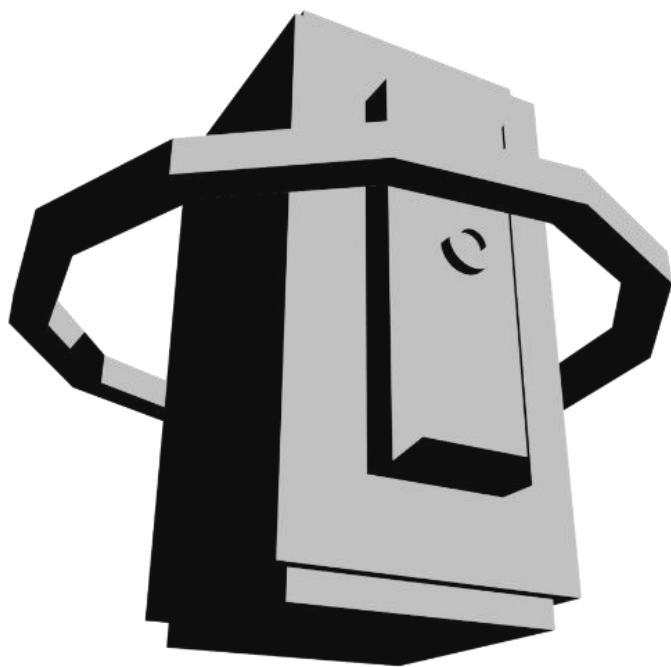
They hang stationary in Fallow Space, anchored in nothing.

They're not just machines, they are proof.

The universe has a skin, a membrane. Two dimensions crowded infinitely with data. Everything that exists | every atom, every heartbeat, is recorded on the ever-expanding storage at the edge of the universe.

What we see; stars, ships, people, is a mirage. A hologram in three-dimensional space, projected from 2D data, flickering into information.

The genius lies in the fact they cannot only access local data on the membrane; but also cut and paste to entangled nodes.



Transfer Computer near Gliese 65 in
Fallow Space

Heart Vitality Monitors

HVMs are a nexus. Machines that keep the Station Hearts from falling. Etching every stutter onto the screen.

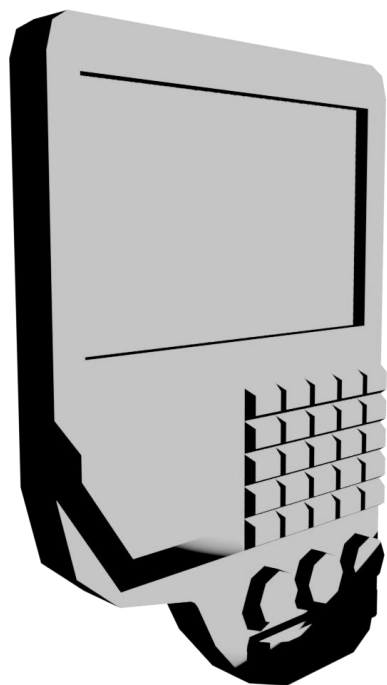
They sense, measure and present the vitals to the community.

« Station Unity: Holistic non-hierarchical relationship status of all residents. Factions and rifts lower unity.

« Debris Frequency: Healthy Hearts require the healing of membrane scars. Clearing fragments keeps the Heart happy.

« Transfer Reliability: Hearts aren't islands. They are entangled with other nodes. If transfer reliability is disrupted, hearts become lonely.

« Resident Equality: The peer-to-peer load. How residents support each other matters. Struggle and aid. The balance of burden.



A Heart Vitality Monitor

Fragmentation

Membrane Scarification

When a computer performs a cut and paste function on the membrane, it's the cut that really alters the fabric of the universe.

Often, a calculation can be off by a miniscule amount and scarification occurs.

Scars on the 2D membrane manifest in 3D space as complexity storms, that leave behind complex fragments.

Complexity Storm Fragments (CSF)

Computers unnaturally disrupt the membrane. The results: random bursts of complexity in 3D space, mirroring 2D scars.

Fragments render computers inoperable for processing transfer. Junk data.

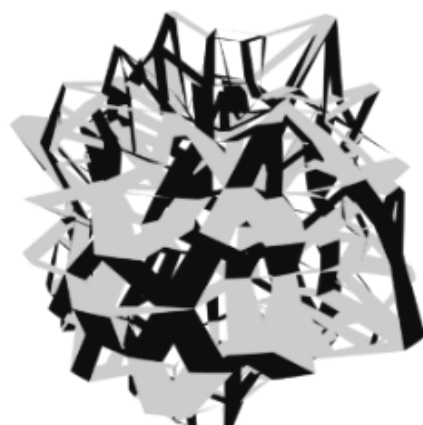


A Complexity Storm Fragment

Randomisation Bomb Fragments (RBF)

Industrial sabotage is an
unfortunate reality.

A synthetic residue remains
after the payload is detonated. It
acts like CSF but is artificial.
Scramblers drop the bombs and
run, leaving stations and their crew
isolated.



A Randomisation Bomb Fragment

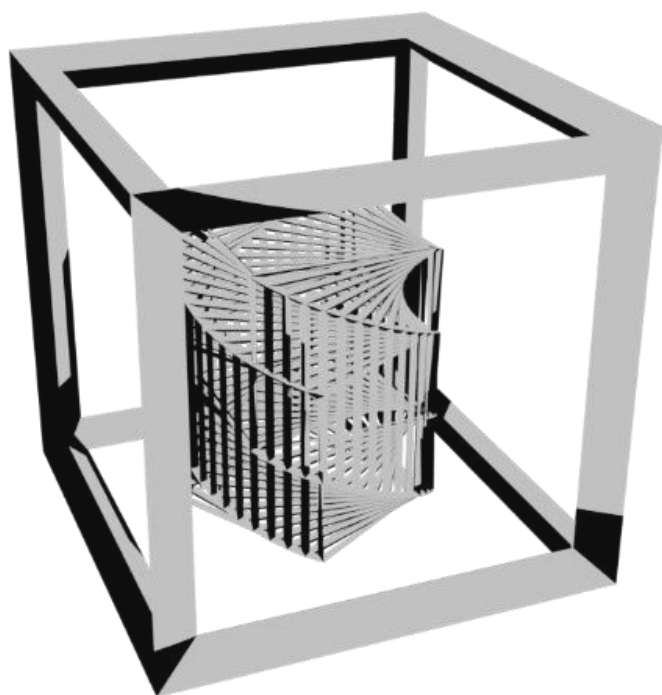
Randomisation Bombs

R-bombs are left by Scramblers to disrupt logistics.

It detonates into an array of RBF, rendering Fallow Space too complex for Computers to do their job.

The methods for making an R-Bomb is extremely complex, the duopoly are thought to have hidden manufacturing plants in obscure gas giants.

R-Bombs and RBF came about as an unfortunate side effect of CCF research.



A Randomisation Bomb

Maintenance and Labor

Drone Classes

Drones, controlled by a skilled crew, clean Fallow Space to ensure a low level of complexity before the next transfer.

They sweep, as a small swarm to collect CSF and RBF littered across the area.

The swarm is specialised mix of classes.

- ~ Velocitors trade cargo space for speed.

- ~ Seekers have enhanced sensors.

- ~ Hules work on a slow burn, designed to bring as many fragments back to the crew as possible in one run.



A Velocitor Class Drone

Drone Crews

Drone crews consist of a Director, Engineer, Analyst and Swarm Pilot.

Drone sweeps function best when the crew is fully in sync, as does the Station Heart.

~ The Director oversees the cleaning of Fallow Space.

~ The Analyst monitors Data coming in from The Computer and scans the membrane for signs of complexity storms.

~ The Engineer oversees the state of all drones in the swarm.

~ The Swarm Pilot takes direction and directly controls the drone swarm.

Together, crews sweep Fallow Space, ensuring low enough complexity for The Computer to

operate. And take R-Bomb (RBF) and Complexity Storm Fragments (CSF) back to the station for processing.

Crew 073 work tirelessly from the Gliese 65 Binary Star System's Station. Ensuring cargo runs are smooth and people can see their loved ones on other nodes.



Drone Crew 078

Scramblers

Socio-economic diversity is present in all systems. It exists on all planets, moons, asteroid mines and Stations.

Some are privileged and others are not. For the latter, there are many occupations available.

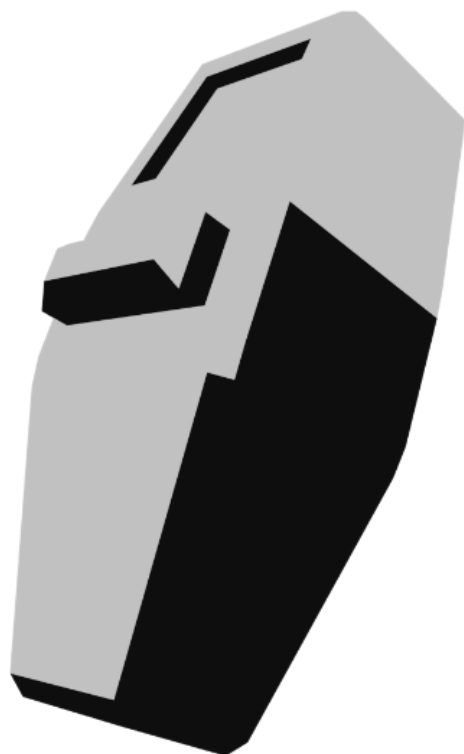
In the social hierarchies of all systems, Scramblers live on the bottom rung.

In a coffin carefully composed of atomically simple materials, with the bare basics of life support, they travel at incredible speed to their destination. Fallow Space. Journeys can take months, sometimes years.

Armed with a minimal 8-bit entertainment system, spitting crunchy, aliased music and plain text narratives, and sometimes no sedation or body-pause device, they take RBFs to disrupt logistics in Fallow Space.

The duopoly of Computer Transfer Logistic Firms pay well, and often, for this service. When an RBF is detonated, stations are isolated from supply and transfer for indefinite periods.

Station residents suffer, and so do the Station Hearts. It's a cruel and unjust practice that is practiced all too often.



A salvaged Scambler Coffin